

VPN Setup and Usage Report

1. Selecting and Signing Up for a Free VPN

I chose ProtonVPN (free tier) as my VPN service. I registered for an account on their official website.

2. Downloading and Installing the VPN Client

I downloaded the official ProtonVPN client for my device and followed the installation prompts. Once installed, I logged in using my account credentials.

3. Connecting to a VPN Server

After opening the VPN client, I selected a free server location (such as the Netherlands or the United States) and clicked "Connect." The client displayed an active connection status.

4. IP Address Verification

To check if my public IP address had changed, I visited [*whatismyipaddress.com*](https://whatismyipaddress.com). Before connecting, my real IP and location appeared. Once connected to the VPN, my IP and location matched the server's region, confirming successful masking of my actual location.

5. Disconnecting and Reconnecting

I disconnected from the VPN server using the client's "Disconnect" button, then reconnected to a different server to verify that each time, my IP address updated accordingly.

6. Connection Status Observations

I monitored the VPN client interface for indicators such as:

- Successful connection status
- Disconnection status
- Server location changes

I took screenshots to document each step as suggested.

7. Benefits and Limitations of VPNs

Benefits:

- Hides the real IP address, protecting privacy.
- Encrypts all internet traffic, safeguarding data from hackers or trackers.
- Allows bypassing of geographic restrictions.

Limitations:

- Internet speed may decrease, especially if the server is far away.
- Free server choices are limited.
- Connection quality and availability can depend on server load.

8. Summary of Experience

The VPN setup was straightforward. Changing server locations worked reliably, and IP address updates proved the service's privacy benefits. Minor speed reductions were noticeable but did not severely impact browsing. Overall, VPNs are effective tools for privacy and security.